

PRIVACY AND SECRECY

My very beloved friends, you are blessed, once again. The streamings of golden rays are around you and fill your very being. In this last lecture of the year, I want to give you yet another outline of divine living, a vision of the Christ consciousness that heals all the wounds of division, confusion, and unnecessary conflict. You may sense that the series of lectures I have given you this past working season was geared to give you such new visions in several respects. These visions will also set the pace and the climate of the work we shall be doing in the next working season.

The particular sequence of lectures may appear, off hand, arbitrary and not necessarily connected, but upon more profound reflection, you will see that there is a meaningful sequence and connection between the topics. In fact, one could not be properly assimilated without the other. All of them form one comprehensive whole. A study in meditation will reveal how all these topics are intricately connected. Every single one of the topics, and all of them together, will open new channels of consciousness in you which, in turn, will make you capable of living the new life that is preparing to evolve on your earth sphere.

In this topic I wish to explore the two concepts of privacy and secrecy. There exists much confusion about these two concepts, a confusion which fosters the aim of the forces of evil and which prevents man from true expansion and from fulfilling all his needs. This confusion also makes closeness and intimacy impossible, which is surely one of man's legitimate needs. Another is his need for privacy. If privacy and secrecy are being confused, either the need for closeness, or the need for privacy with its many important aspects, must be shortchanged.

So let us now examine the difference between these two concepts. Let us clearly understand what each means, contains, and what its ramifications are. Privacy is a legitimate need of the soul. You need to be by and with yourself. You need time alone in which you can delve into your depths and find new levels of inner reality, undisturbed by influences and vibrations from others, even the most favorable. You need at times even periods in which what you essentially desire to share with all your loved ones needs to be kept for yourself until it ripens sufficiently for sharing. It needs time to complete itself whether this be a thought, a new state of consciousness, an artistic creation.

Such periods of privacy do not mean isolation or separateness. They merely indicate a necessary state of aloneness, of being by yourself to find more of yourself. The problem is always that every divine reality also has a distorted, diabolic counterpart. If privacy is being sought in order to avoid contact, it is such a distortion. If privacy is being avoided because the anxiety it may at first produce is not explored and understood as to its true meaning, then it is, again, a distortion.

Many individuals are completely oblivious of the fact that they neglect their need for privacy. They may, at times, be alone as result of circumstances beyond their control. But even then, they

manage to clutter up their inner being with surface thought material, with outer or inner noise, so as to avoid this deep inner contact for which the soul craves. Human beings who live in perpetually crowded conditions may have produced these very conditions because they desire an outer "reason" for being prevented from being alone. But by the same token, it may be equally true that human beings live in such crowded conditions, but somehow they manage inner, and occasionally even outer, privacy in the midst of all the busyness that surrounds them.

It is also true that those who are predominantly by themselves may have created these conditions because of their fear of contact. But if fear of contact exists at all, it is primarily fear of contact with self and secondarily contact with others. Consequently their aloneness will not fill their need for privacy. As mentioned, they will be alone without making use of the opportunity, just as they will be with others without making use of the opportunity to forge true contact and intimacy.

Now what about secrecy? Secrecy is never positive, at least not in its real sense. We are not talking of the so-called "secret" one keeps to prepare a lovely surprise for a loved one. This is not really a secret, for it is finally revealed as a joyful occasion. Secrets always hide something negative, otherwise they would not be kept secret. This is very important to realize. Although it is quite obvious and not at all obscure or subtle or difficult to recognize, it is surprising how often this fact is totally overlooked. Whatever the secret may be that you wish to keep from another or others, if you look closer it will not be difficult to discern that you wish to hide something that is not palatable for someone. Either it is you who wishes something hidden from others, or another person wishes to involve you into keeping something negative or destructive hidden. If these hidden things -- the secrets -- were revealed, they could be dealt with, they could be totally dissolved so that a beautiful positive creation could take their place. But by keeping the secret; negative thoughts, dishonest actions, maligning, destructive behavior patterns are being maintained and continually being nurtured.

The person who has a stake in keeping something secret -- either by himself or in conjunction with another person or other persons -- is perfectly well aware of the fact that it is something negative; otherwise he would not need in the least to keep this secret, whatever it may be. To plead righteousness about the keeping of a secret is therefore absurd. But what usually happens is that privacy is being used to camouflage the intent to keep secrets. In other words, the secretive person will use his right and need for privacy in order to conceal that he really keeps something secret. Thus the weapon of the forces of darkness is always to confuse and use a truth to cover up a lie.

Privacy never intends to keep secrets. In fact, just the opposite is true. What ripens in privacy is, when divinely inspired, later always shared with others and given on to them. It is never meant to hide anything. Only dishonesty, lies, negative intentionality, destructiveness in one way or another, needs to be hidden from others. Nothing that is true and beautiful needs to be kept secret -- not ever.

Sometimes the excuse "I will not be understood" or "I will be unjustly criticized" is used as a rationalization for keeping secrets. Again this is not valid. For if one is in truth, understanding from others will not be such a great necessity as to create impenetrable walls between the self and others. If one is in truth, one makes the effort to make them understand and to work with their criticism as a further tool to explore the reality of the situation one feels inclined to keep secret.

He who keeps a secret fears not being in truth, or he even knows he is not being in truth but he has no intention whatever to change this fact. In that way he is dishonest because he knows that the other person may react to this fact, but he wishes to avoid this. In other words, he wishes the respect and love that he may not be able to earn if the secret were disclosed.

Keeping secrets is therefore always, in the final analysis, a theft. It is a cheating action that wants a result that cannot or may not come about if the secret were disclosed. Keeping secrets also means to avoid effort and responsibility to find an equitable, honest, and truthful solution in which the other or others can participate.

Secrets are always an antithesis to relationship, to intimacy, to real and fulfilling contact. The secretive person is never emotionally fulfilled. He keeps a wall of separation between himself and others and then wonders why he feels so alone and misunderstood. It never occurs to him to put two and two together. He even often blames others for his state and uses this to justify his secretiveness instead of doing the only valid, meaningful, and intelligent thing: to spill out all secrets and make himself as transparent as is possible. This is not an easy or quick thing to achieve. It requires patience, time, effort, and all the good will that can be mastered.

Often an important reason for secretiveness is the fear of self-exposure. The fear says "If I show myself how I really am, they will not love me." In this reasoning, if it can be called that, certain blatant facts are being ignored. For instance, it is assumed that the love, respect, or approval of others is more important than one's own. It is being ignored that the courage and honesty of transparency, no matter what shameful facets may have to be revealed, creates at first more self-esteem than the secretiveness ever could. And therefore eventually it must also create esteem and love from others.

This path is blatantly designed to gradually but surely eliminate all secrets. First you learn to no longer have secrets from yourself. You experience that there exists a great deal of material that you had ignored, that was unconscious, that is secret from your conscious mind. Then, this same honesty and openness you have acquired toward yourself, you learn to apply it also to others. If you go steadily that way, you cannot help experience that this is the only way to be, to exist. It is the only way your need for contact can be fulfilled. The only way you can live without fear and anxiety, without shame and hiding, without pretenses and facades. The relief of this kind of living is a much headier wine than any pseudosolution could ever be. Those who have begun to taste it can no longer stand for long to revert back to secret living in any area or respect, no matter what may come up.

If you have negative thoughts about others, suspicious opinions or accusations, instead of nurturing them secretly for yourself or sharing them with a third person as a mutually kept secret, you will bring it all out into the open. Doing so indicates that your will to be in truth is greater than your negative opinion, your accusations, your suspicions. You will proceed into a journey within the great journey of life to explore what the particular truth of this situation is. You cannot fail to be enlightened with the real, peace-bringing, unifying truth if you are committed to it more than to anything else. Wanting to preserve your secret, on the other hand, indicates clearly that you have no commitment to the truth -- probably not even to the truth that you have a stake in -- and that you have a desire for maintaining your negative opinions, accusations, and suspicions precisely because, deep inside of you, you already know that you are not in truth but do not wish to admit this.

Accusations that are being made publicly do not necessarily indicate openness, a converse to secrecy. It may merely mean that hostile and aggressive factors supersede secrecy.

It is easy to see that the new man and the new woman are incapable of abiding secrets. They cannot be borne in the newly emerging consciousness. They are experienced as an unbearable burden, which it actually is. The spiritual form of a secret is exactly that -- a heavy burden. The more enlightened conscious becomes, the more infused with the Christ spirit, the speedier the burden will be dissolved in the most productive and creative way possible.

You have begun to experience this new mode of living in your own growing community. This is precisely what is taking place -- an ever increasing openness and transparency in which all secrets of self and others are being experienced as insufferable burdens, as hindrances to light and love. The price for keeping a secret becomes too high, too absurd. No effort to eliminate secrets so that the soul can stand clear and clean -- visible for all to see -- is too high. This must be the goal. It applies to all manner of relationships: to man/woman partnerships, to every kind of friendship, and finally also to the relationships between countries.

As a result of keeping negative aspects secret, it is also impossible to reveal the best of self. One feels embarrassed about it. Or simply one's innermost thoughts, dreams, and desires feel shameful. To begin with, these aspects are often far from shameful or bad. But something in the soul turns them negative as a result of the veil of secrecy that is being established. The mere fact that one believes there must be something hidden, creates an aura of fog, of darkness that gradually encompasses the best in the person. It is therefore essential that this fog be dissolved, whether what is hidden is outright negative or only becomes so as a result of the hiding process.

The process of dissolving the hidden secrets consists, to a large degree, of what you already do on this path. You muster the courage to expose what was hitherto a secret. In no way have you ever had occasion to regret this step. For always you have found more love, more respect, more friendship, more help, more recognition of your real values, not to speak of the relief of losing an unbearable burden. The clarity, the sense of liberation, and the heady wine of no longer pretending in any way are the direct doorway to the self-esteem you so desperately looked for in a false way before.

If your self-revealing seems to have elicited more criticism and censure rather than more love and understanding, I would say to you, my friends, that your self-revealing must surely have occurred in a distorted way. It is easy to confuse the real way with the false one. The real way is the absolute willingness to follow the will of God; to let go of every cherished attitude, action, or goal if they should prove to be damaging and counter to divine law; to use those to whom you reveal yourself as mirrors that help you to reconsider some of your previous patterns. Their reaction should not be your inflexible rule that you must abide, but should make you thoughtful and truly willing to reconsider whatever it is.

The false way of self-revealing and dissolving secrets is the childish, lower self aim that says, in effect: "If I show you my secrets, I demand that you approve of them and of me regardless of how destructive they may be. If you do not, I will accuse you of letting me down and will use this as a proof that it does not pay to be open." So be careful, my friends, when you adjudge the results of

your self-revealing. The key always lies deep within you: are you really moved by the sincere desire to be in truth and to do the will of God?

On the other hand, you also need to clearly understand when there exists a real violation of your privacy. When others try to pry, out of their own negative motives, out of a sickly kind of curiosity that they may wish to use against you, or because they want to prove something against you so as to make themselves feel better and to enhance their deteriorated self-value, then you should indeed close the doors to them. But the fact is that you can never truly recognize the distinction between actual prying and violation of your privacy and from genuine concern for you and the desire to relate to the real you on the part of others -- unless you are willing to give up all secrets, unless you have already begun to do so. As long as you harbor a stake to keep yourself hidden, your assessment of others' motives will be very shaky and not reliable.

Self-revealing, openness, transparency is not only a new habit that needs to be acquired with patience, devotion, and perseverance, due to recognizing its importance for you and those around you with whom you long to relate. It is also an art that can be, need be, learned. Often the hesitancy and inhibitions that exist to begin with can be removed when you learn how to express yourself, how to convey what first seems unconveyable. Has it not frequently occurred to you that you relayed a dream quite adequately, once you started it, although you were first convinced it cannot be explained? In the four walls of your inner self, thoughts and attitudes, experiences and feelings seem so vague, so diffused, so unexplainable that you do not even attempt to convey them. But once you know it is possible to do so, even if not all of the shadings and nuances come out one hundred percent correct, you will make efforts and you will be surprised to what extent you can make yourself clear and reach others who may have quite similar inner experiences and thus can emotionally connect with you sooner and better than you may have suspected.

The point I want to make is that communication is an essential part of self-revealing and openness. Effort is needed, a lot of effort, but this effort will be highly rewarded. What first appears to be embarrassing, only seems that way because you cannot really put it in the proper words. Once you try, these words will come. A new wonderful art of self-expression and articulateness will develop that in itself will enhance your sense of security and adequacy. Your initial inability to express yourself adequately is totally due to your not really wanting it and therefore not allowing God to infill you. The Holy Spirit will inspire you with the appropriate words, and this will remove the walls you have built around you.

Let us examine the quality of the various human relationships in the light of this topic. The most intimate of all relationships -- between a man and a woman who love each other and intend to share themselves with one another, completely -- depends on the ability to be without secrets. This includes the outer ones as well as the inner, more subtle ones. If the risk is not taken to bring everything of the self into play, the bliss that is expected can never materialize. I have discussed this before in connection with the specific topic of the relationships between mates. I need to repeat it here in context with the personality's tendency to keep the self secret. The false belief that the self is otherwise not acceptable must be challenged again and again. The risk needs to be taken again and again, step by step, until all is out in the open. Then the ongoing process of communicating the inner processes and sharing them can begin. Again it is not a one-time goal that is now achieved for good. Of course there may exist a great deal of residual material that you have accumulated. Once this is emptied out, and all is made known of you, the ongoing process can begin. For the soul is

not a static, fixed thing. It constantly moves and changes, forever producing new inner experiences, new feelings, new thought material, new aims, new dreams. But once you have emptied yourself, the dynamic process of soul development can be shared much more easily. The art of communicating, of self-expression, of explaining yourself adequately grows as you grow. Thus you become an increasingly open channel for divine inspiration, which also affects the choice of words, the finer shades and distinctions that seem so difficult to put into words, the tone of voice that also contributes to making yourself clear. Thus what was once a confined prison of your inner self becomes a wide open field, ever more clearly available for all others, that reaches the infinite horizons of divine possibilities. A state of mind grows in which there is nothing to hide, in which hiding seems utterly absurd and being totally transparent the greatest joy.

How else can you know your real value? Only when you risk to present whatever you are now. In this process you will inevitably find that there is so much more to you than you feared. How else can you find fulfillment and squelch your thirst for being open with others, for attaining intimacy? This longing can never be fulfilled, no matter how hard you may try to deny it or give it pseudofulfillments.

The word friendship becomes a farce if you feel there is anything to hide between yourself and the friend. It is at best very limited. And you will never really know whether you are loved and accepted, you must always fear and distrust as long as the risk is not being taken to show the friend all you are, all you have kept hidden. But this of course always includes the basic willingness to change what is a lower self act, a lower self goal, a lower self activity. It requires the trust that higher self goals and activities will provide you much better with what you need. If this trust is lacking, then this is what you need to share -- and perhaps receive help with.

The whole idea of this pathwork is obviously designed to remove the secrets and to make yourself available. If you look back on your progress so far, from this point of view, you will see quite clearly that to whatever degree you have liberated yourself and improved your life circumstances, to whatever degree you have gained new self-confidence and a sense of your own value, to whatever degree you trust God and life more and know of divine abundance, it is due to the courage of openness and revealing of outer and/or inner subtle secrets. Look where you still keep hiding, and you will find the key to where your life is still blocked from the fulfillment that is waiting for you.

When you look at your world, at the interaction between countries, it will become apparent how much this factor weighs. The interrelationships between countries is more marked than any other relationship by secretiveness, pretense, and hiding. Openness between the governments of different countries is not even considered as viable. It is taken for granted by all concerned that opaqueness is sound diplomacy. In this area mankind is far behind where it could and should be, and far behind the other areas of human relationships although they, too, still leave something to be desired. If you view the general attitudes in marriage, you will also recognize to what extent mates keep secrets from one another -- not only about the past and the present as far as actual actions and experiences are concerned, but also about their thoughts and feelings and inner shading of experience. Is it any wonder that marriage does not seem to work out very well and that mates cannot stay together? Yet in this respect it is so much better than in the relationship between different governments. And it is there that most distrust, most deceit, most strife exists. As long as humanity does not begin to envision an altogether new way of interrelating, peace cannot truly be

established; sharing of the riches God has provided cannot take place; justice and brotherhood will remain mere empty phrases. In short, the willingness to be open must exist. It must be recognized that this is a prerequisite for a life of peace, joy, and harmony between all the peoples of this earth. It must then be learned painstakingly, just as you as individuals do.

You are pioneers, bringing the new model to this world. I have said this before, and I say it again, this time in connection with this topic. In establishing your community life, you encounter basically the same problem that humanity as a whole encounters in establishing society. You see clearly that those who keep themselves secret, who do not share all of themselves, represent a dark barricade that hinders the fabric of the whole. You need to make this fact understood by those who do not dare as yet to be real. You need to know it for yourself. You will learn increasingly, slowly perhaps but yet inexorably, to present yourself in totality, without any false self-projections. To whatever degree you do not trust the process of a "secretless life," you must understand that you encourage a false self-projection. Your secrets mean exactly that, "I want you to see me, not as I am, but as I pretend to be." Once you clearly see this fact, how can you imagine that this does not have the gravest consequences on your relationship with yourself, with others, with your God? How could this possibly not effect your entire outer and inner life and those with whom you are involved and attempt to establish a desirable relationship?

Just imagine, try to visualize, what life is like when you know that there is nothing ever to hide. And if you feel that there is, perhaps that which you hide is really something damaging, destructive for yourself and/or others and should be revealed all the more because you need help in recognizing what causes your desire for this act or attitude. You then need help to change your inner mechanisms so that you will no longer need to desire a destructive act or attitude.

Or perhaps what you believe should be kept hidden is really a beautiful aspect of you and should be shared. Or perhaps you only think it is bad and need the experience of exposing it before you can really be convinced that you have nothing to hide. Even that which is your lower self is not to be hidden, so that it can be healed and transformed. Imagine the feeling of no longer hiding anything from anyone. Imagine the freedom, like shedding a heavy armor. Imagine the joy and the good healthy pride, your head held high, your eye clear in knowing you can truly be open to all.

Only when this state of consciousness is being achieved can the true unfoldment begin. Your limitless potentials for greatness, for creativity, for still hidden talents, for your universality and uniqueness, for your essence and your beauty can stream forth only when the confinement of hiding is removed. The process of self-unfoldment begins with removing the walls of secretiveness, the confinement of hiding and deceiving the world about who you are now, and it continues with liberating the best in you only after this has been accomplished. Of course the process often overlaps and changes back and forth. As one layer or aspect of hiding is being dissolved, new qualities and assets develop that you have never known. Then you return to other areas of hiding that you had not even been clearly aware of before, so that more of your potentials can begin to unfold.

Can you visualize a world in which no one ever hides anything any longer from anyone else? Is that not paradise? This is the direction in which evolution moves, my friends. This is what the new age signifies. How can Christ in you truly express through and to you if you have any hidden agenda? How can your divinity unfold if you are not free and if you continue to project a false self

into the world? Do not rationalize it by pretending it is to preserve your privacy. Look at the real motives, at the real reasons why you maintain this painful and unnecessary state of isolation and deception -- for that is what it truly amounts to.

There are fundamentally three reasons for the resistance to give up your secrets: (1) the fear that your lower self makes you all bad and your unwillingness to risk taking the chance that this is not so, that others will not reject you nor will you find it necessary to do so yourself; (2) ignorance that there is a way to be learned of communicating all that now seems incommunicable; unwillingness to learn the process gradually by small steps; (3) fear of being too vulnerable when all the hard shells fall off (and secrets are certainly one of the hardest layers). The common denominator of all these three factors is the resistance to go with all of yourself to God and trust His will. It is perpetuated by following the voices of the dark forces who inspire you to trust your false, destructive, separating devices for safety and for the resolution of your problems. You need to become aware of these influences, and you desperately need to challenge them and refute them. New choices of action, behavior, and of seeking solutions will have to be actively made by you.

Before terminating this lecture, I wish to speak more about the third factor, fear of vulnerability. This vulnerability goes beyond the obvious fear of being less "protected" from hurt and disappointment. This fear is an outright illusion and easy to discover as such, once the courage to risk is summoned. But there is another kind of vulnerability I wish to speak about. As you become more open, more accessible, more unhidden, new capacities of perception grow. What you perceived previously only dimly, becomes more and more acute, more clearly defined. In many areas of life, this is immediately and directly a tremendous asset. The only thing is that this desirable result is totally ignored by the personality because there is too much darkness and fog present to know reality. Therefore the incentive is lacking.

But there is also another effect created by this newly evolved vulnerability, that is not immediately experienced as desirable. It is a grieving pain about the destruction caused by evil. It is healthy and good when this state grows in you, when you can experience this. It manifests in different ways, and the more aware of it you become, the more you will experience this very healthy pain. You may feel a pain when you see God's gifts in nature being willfully destroyed. You may feel a pain about the suffering on this plane of existence. For example, animals who need to be the prey of other animals in order to sustain their life feel deeply that they fulfill their function. And in one sense this suffering is certainly much less than the suffering inflicted willfully by indifference and cruelty from man. Yet, the fact that they have to go through this phase of their own evolution is painful although there is an intrinsic rightness about it. These are incarnated aspects of consciousness that need these experiences, but they are, nevertheless, on the level of manifestation, much more innocent than man who has a consciousness and awareness that gives him much more responsibility.

What I say here may sound contradictory, yet it is not. I must ask you to try to understand this in your depth from which a true grasping will come. Compassion and love, gratitude for the beauty of creation, appreciation of and joy about it must also create a deep pain that needs to be suffered. It is ever so different from neurotic pain, from the kind of pain by association, the pain of masochistic self-punishment that identifies with what appears to be victims. This living, healthy, loving pain is also the threshold to joy and ecstasy.

Another aspect of this pain is the recognition of damage inflicted by thoughts of untruth about your fellow human beings; thoughts of maligning and unwarranted suspicion; inner and/or outer acts of factual, psychological, emotional, and spiritual cheating that imposes unfair disadvantages on others even though such cheating may well be camouflaged and rationalized away until the consciousness truly ignores it and fights with all its might against recognition.

As long as these pains are denied, the price is much higher, for it cannot help but turn against him who inflicts these pains or who colludes with those who do by passively standing by. Many self-defeating patterns are never connected with pains you have unwittingly and blindly inflicted because you have not allowed yourself to know and feel them. It seemed too tempting to follow the way of the dark forces and too undesirable to give them up. But not only your own pain about this is feared and avoided, thereby accruing into debilitating guilt and indirect self-punishment; you also need to feel the liberating pain where it has nothing to do with you, where you simply see it existing on this sphere and allow this experience to strengthen your determination to become an ever stronger fighter in the legion fighting for the forces of light.

So, my beloved friends, when the walls of separation and secretiveness fall from you, you step out into a beautiful world of light, of goodness, of singing joy, of eternal life, of fearless existence. This world can only exist in a defenseless person, free from armoring, free from denying the soft vulnerability that can experience all suffering created by the forces of evil. If you harden yourself against this kind of pain, you also deny the joy that is meant to be yours for all eternity.

The blessings of all the angels accompany you, the blessings of the Highest flows through them to you, enriching and guiding your life. The presence of the Highest, of the Creator, lives in your heart and soul if you only will see and feel it. The short period of time in which I will not give you lectures or answer your questions will be fully utilized by all those who will wish to do so, so that we cannot really speak of interruption. It is simply a time of outbreathing and refueling while your inner path progresses and assimilates. Be always aware that you are here on this earth plane to find your true being and fulfill for God. Live in Him.

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